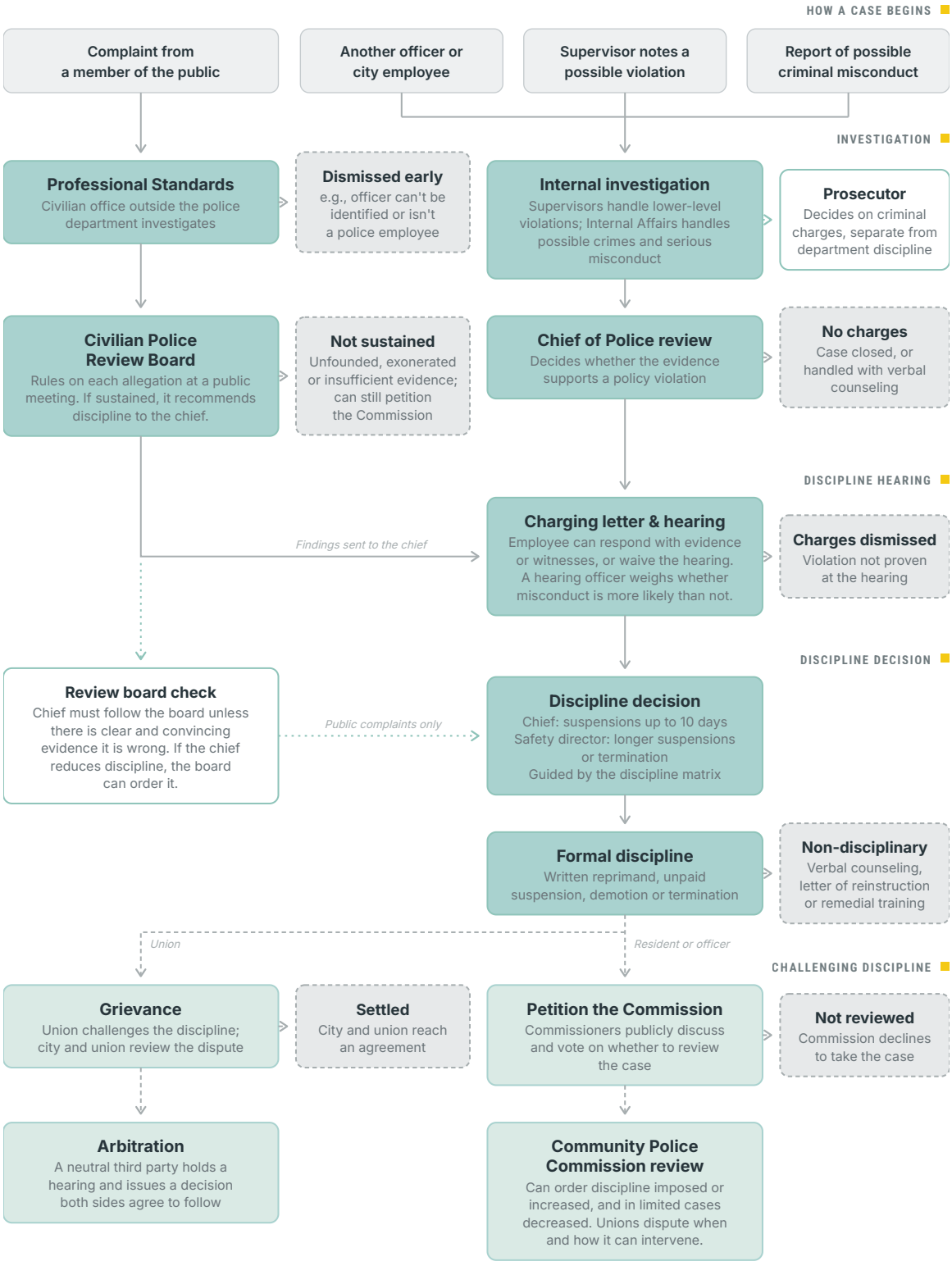
SIGNAL CLEVELAND

How a misconduct complaint moves through police discipline

A case can start four ways. Complaints from the public go to a civilian investigator and review board; other cases are investigated inside the department and reviewed by the police chief. Both paths lead to a hearing before the chief or safety director decides any penalty, which can then be challenged through a union grievance or a petition to the Community Police Commission.



Dashed boxes show where a case can leave the formal discipline process.

Dotted lines show parallel or oversight steps: the prosecutor's separate criminal review and the review board's power to overrule the chief.

Dashed arrows show optional challenges after discipline is imposed. The Commission's authority to intervene is disputed by the police unions.

Sources: Cleveland city charter; Cleveland Division of Police policies; Office of Professional Standards and Civilian Police Review Board manuals; police union contracts.